Project Completion Report

Project Title: Women's Day Home Visits
Organization: Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Reference Number: ADA/2023/001
Project Location: Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Implementation Date: March 8, 2023
Total Beneficiaries: 12 widows
Total Budget: $600 USD
Report Date: March 22, 2023

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1. Executive Summary

On March 8, 2023 — International Women's Day — the Apoti Development Association (ADA) conducted a full-day door-to-door outreach to 12 vulnerable widows in Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon. A team of 6 volunteers wearing special Women's Day edition ADA branded t-shirts delivered comprehensive food packages to each widow at her home, combining material support with prayer, emotional encouragement, and personal interaction. Each package included a 10kg bag of Lune d'Afrique rice, a 5L jerry can of cooking oil, an orange bucket filled with soap and seasonings, and fresh bread from Neiforbi Bakery. The project was completed under budget at 345,000 CFA ($575 USD) due to wholesale pricing on several items. The intimate, individual approach — visiting each woman in her own home rather than gathering them at a central location — preserved dignity and enabled deeply personal connections.

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2. Project Background

2.1 Context

International Women's Day provides a global platform to celebrate women's achievements and advocate for their rights. For vulnerable widows in Buea — many of whom live in modest wooden plank homes, isolated from family support networks, and facing daily food insecurity — the day can pass unnoticed. ADA designed this project to ensure that 12 of these women would be personally honoured on a day dedicated to celebrating women worldwide.

2.2 Organizational Context

By March 2023, ADA had been operational for over a year, having conducted multiple community outreach projects including home visits, food distributions, and vocational training programmes. The organization had developed a proven model of door-to-door, faith-based outreach and maintained an active network of identified beneficiaries and community contacts in Buea.

2.3 Rationale

The project was motivated by:

- The desire to mark International Women's Day with tangible action for the most vulnerable women in the community
- ADA's established model of individual home visits that preserves dignity and enables personal connection
- The ongoing food insecurity faced by widows in Buea, particularly those living alone
- A conviction that every woman deserves to feel valued and remembered, especially on a day dedicated to women globally

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3. Objectives vs Achievements

#	Planned Objective	Achievement	Status
1	Deliver food packages to 12 widows at their homes	All 12 widows received complete packages at home	✅ Achieved
2	Provide personal interaction, prayer, and emotional support	Prayer and personal time spent at each home	✅ Achieved
3	Preserve dignity through individual home visits	All deliveries made door-to-door; no central gathering	✅ Achieved
4	Mark Women's Day with visible community solidarity	Team wore special Women's Day branded shirts throughout	✅ Achieved
5	Complete all visits within single day (March 8)	All 12 visits completed on March 8, 2023	✅ Achieved

Overall Achievement Rate: 100%

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4. Activities Implemented

4.1 Preparation Phase (March 1–7)

The team confirmed the list of 12 beneficiary widows, planned the delivery route across Buea, and procured all food items. Rice (Lune d'Afrique brand, 10kg bags) and cooking oil (5L jerry cans) were purchased from the market, with some items secured at wholesale rates. Orange buckets were filled with bars of soap and assorted seasonings. Fresh bread was ordered from Neiforbi Bakery for morning collection on March 8. Special Women's Day edition ADA branded t-shirts were produced for all 6 volunteers.

4.2 Delivery Day — March 8, 2023

Beginning early morning, the team of 6 volunteers loaded the hired vehicle with all 12 food packages and set out on a planned route through Buea. At each home, volunteers:

- Greeted the widow and introduced the purpose of the visit
- Presented the complete food package (rice, cooking oil, bucket with soap and seasonings, fresh bread)
- Spent time in personal conversation and prayer
- Offered emotional support and encouragement
- Wished each woman a happy International Women's Day

The visits continued throughout the day until all 12 homes had been reached.

4.3 Personal Interactions

Each visit was characterized by warmth and genuine human connection. Volunteers took time to listen, pray, and simply be present with each widow. The personal nature of the visits — arriving at a woman's own doorstep with gifts and words of encouragement — communicated value and care in a way that a group distribution event cannot replicate.

One recipient was visibly overwhelmed with emotion upon receiving her package and the personal attention of the team. The moment underscored the profound impact that simple acts of recognition can have on individuals who often feel forgotten.

4.4 Living Conditions Observed

The homes visited were predominantly wooden plank construction — weathered structures reflecting the modest conditions in which these widows live. The visits reinforced ADA's understanding of the material vulnerability of this population and the importance of continued support.

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5. Beneficiaries Reached

Category	Number
Widows visited at home	12
Complete food packages delivered	12
Prayer sessions conducted	12
Volunteers deployed	6
Homes reached in single day	12

Package Contents (per beneficiary)

Item	Specification
Rice	10kg bag, Lune d'Afrique brand
Cooking oil	5L jerry can
Orange bucket	Filled with soap and assorted seasonings
Bread	Fresh package from Neiforbi Bakery

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6. Outcomes & Impact

6.1 Immediate Outcomes

- **Food security (short-term):** Each widow received a substantial food package — 10kg of rice, 5L of cooking oil, seasonings, and fresh bread — sufficient for approximately 2–3 weeks of meals
- **Household supplies:** Soap and reusable orange bucket provided practical household utility beyond food
- **Spiritual and emotional support:** All 12 widows received personal prayer and encouragement in their own homes
- **Dignity preserved:** The door-to-door approach ensured no widow had to travel, queue, or receive assistance in a public setting
- **Women's Day recognition:** Each woman was personally acknowledged and celebrated on International Women's Day

6.2 Emotional Impact

The project's most significant impact was emotional and relational. For women who often live in isolation, the arrival of a team of young volunteers — wearing celebratory shirts, carrying gifts, and offering genuine warmth — communicated a powerful message: you are seen, you are valued, you are not forgotten. One widow's visible emotional response captured the depth of this impact.

6.3 Organizational Outcomes

- Reinforced ADA's model of dignified, individual outreach
- Demonstrated capacity to coordinate 12 home visits in a single day with a 6-person team
- Strengthened volunteer team cohesion and commitment
- Created documentation for future reporting and fundraising

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7. Budget Performance

- **Budgeted:** 360,000 CFA ($600 USD)
- **Actual Spend:** 345,000 CFA ($575 USD)
- **Variance:** –15,000 CFA ($25 USD under budget)
- **Budget Utilization:** 95.8%
- **Reason for savings:** Several food items purchased at wholesale rates

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8. Challenges & Lessons Learned

8.1 Challenges Encountered

Challenge	Description	How It Was Addressed
Route logistics	Visiting 12 homes across Buea in a single day required careful route planning	Pre-planned route with geographic clustering; started early morning
Perishable items	Fresh bread needed to remain fresh throughout a full day of deliveries	Collected bread early morning from Neiforbi Bakery; delivered bread homes first where possible
Emotional intensity	Repeated encounters with vulnerable women in difficult conditions was emotionally demanding for volunteers	Team supported each other throughout the day; debriefed together afterward
Time management	Balancing meaningful personal interaction with the need to reach all 12 homes	Allocated approximate time per visit while remaining flexible for moments requiring extended presence

8.2 Lessons Learned

1. **Individual visits communicate extraordinary value.** The door-to-door approach, while more logistically demanding than a central gathering, creates a qualitatively different experience for beneficiaries. Being sought out at home communicates personal worth in a way that attending an event cannot.

2. **Themed occasions amplify impact.** Linking the outreach to International Women's Day — with branded shirts and intentional messaging — elevated the visits from routine food delivery to a celebration of each woman's identity and worth.

3. **Six volunteers is optimal for 12 visits in one day.** The team size allowed for meaningful interaction at each home while maintaining momentum through the route. Fewer would have been rushed; more would have been logistically complex.
4. **Wholesale purchasing yields meaningful savings.** Buying in bulk for 12 packages generated a 4% saving that can be redirected to future projects.
5. **Fresh bread adds a special touch.** The inclusion of bakery bread — a non-essential but celebratory item — distinguished this from routine food distribution and reinforced the Women's Day celebration theme.
6. **Emotional responses should be honoured, not rushed.** When a beneficiary is overwhelmed with emotion, the team must be prepared to pause, be present, and allow the moment its full weight.

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9. Sustainability and Future Plans

This project establishes a model for annual Women's Day outreach that can be replicated and scaled:

- **Annual tradition:** Women's Day home visits can become a recurring ADA programme each March 8
- **Scalable model:** The same approach can accommodate more beneficiaries with additional volunteers and vehicles
- **Beneficiary relationships:** Regular visits strengthen trust and enable ADA to monitor changing needs over time
- **Volunteer engagement:** Themed events with branded shirts build team identity and attract new volunteers
- **Community visibility:** Visible outreach on a recognized international day raises ADA's profile and demonstrates impact

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10. Photos & Documentation

Photographs were taken during the home visits with the verbal consent of beneficiaries. These images document:

- Volunteers in special Women's Day ADA branded t-shirts
- Food packages being delivered at beneficiary homes
- Rice bags (Lune d'Afrique brand), jerry cans of cooking oil, orange buckets with soap and seasonings
- Fresh bread packages from Neiforbi Bakery
- Wooden plank homes and living conditions of beneficiaries
- Personal interactions and prayer moments

📁 **Photo archive location:** Project files maintained in ADA's internal archive under reference ADA/2023/001. Photos available upon request for reporting and fundraising purposes, subject to beneficiary privacy considerations.

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11. Conclusion

The Women's Day Home Visits project achieved all objectives, delivering complete food packages and personal encouragement to 12 vulnerable widows in Buea on International Women's Day 2023. The project's defining characteristic was its intimate, individual approach — a team of 6 volunteers spending an entire day

going from home to home, carrying rice and bread and prayer to women who might otherwise have passed March 8 unnoticed.

The image that captures this project's essence is not the logistics of 12 deliveries or the efficiency of route planning — it is the moment a widow, standing in the doorway of her weathered wooden plank home, was overwhelmed with emotion at the sight of young people who had come specifically to honour her. That moment — repeated in quieter ways at 11 other doorsteps — is what ADA exists to create.

Material support addresses hunger. Personal visits address invisibility. On International Women's Day 2023, ADA addressed both.

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12. Prepared By

ADA Project Team
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Report prepared: March 2023
Reference: ADA/2023/001

"She is clothed with strength and dignity; she can laugh at the days to come." — Proverbs 31:25